

Executive Summary:

This document outlines the professional portfolio for James Ihlenfeldt. The portfolio website aims to attract software engineering and game development recruiters. Various pages showcase the skills, previous games, projects, and reviews and analyses of James Ihlenfeldt.

In-depth research was conducted to support every decision made. This included researching what recruiters look for and what the "ideal candidate" looks like for relevant roles. Colour theory and psychology informed the colour palette of the portfolio website. Extensive testing for colour blindness and colour contrast was done to ensure accessibility for all users. Typography choices for the body and heading text were based on foundational knowledge norms, such as using serif fonts for headings and sans-serif for body text, creating a clear visual hierarchy. Alignment, repetition, contrast, and proximity were all informed by Robin P. Williams' *The Non-Designer's Design Book* [1]. A single-column layout was used to support a mobile-first responsive design. The appropriate use of whitespace eases the cognitive load on the user, with more whitespace applied in areas of heavy information.

Interactive elements were incorporated into the design, including a carousel of images, dropdown menus, a JS-driven navbar, and image slideshows.

A background in video game design influenced several elements of the website.

These include buttons that mimic a directional pad, or "D-pad," found on console controllers, as well as the use of a bright yellow accent colour, which mirrors the use of yellow paint in video games to draw attention to important areas.

Files are organised with industry standards in mind, with CSS, JS, HTML, and images each housed in their own dedicated folder. This allows for easy referencing within the code.

Information architecture & Site Structure

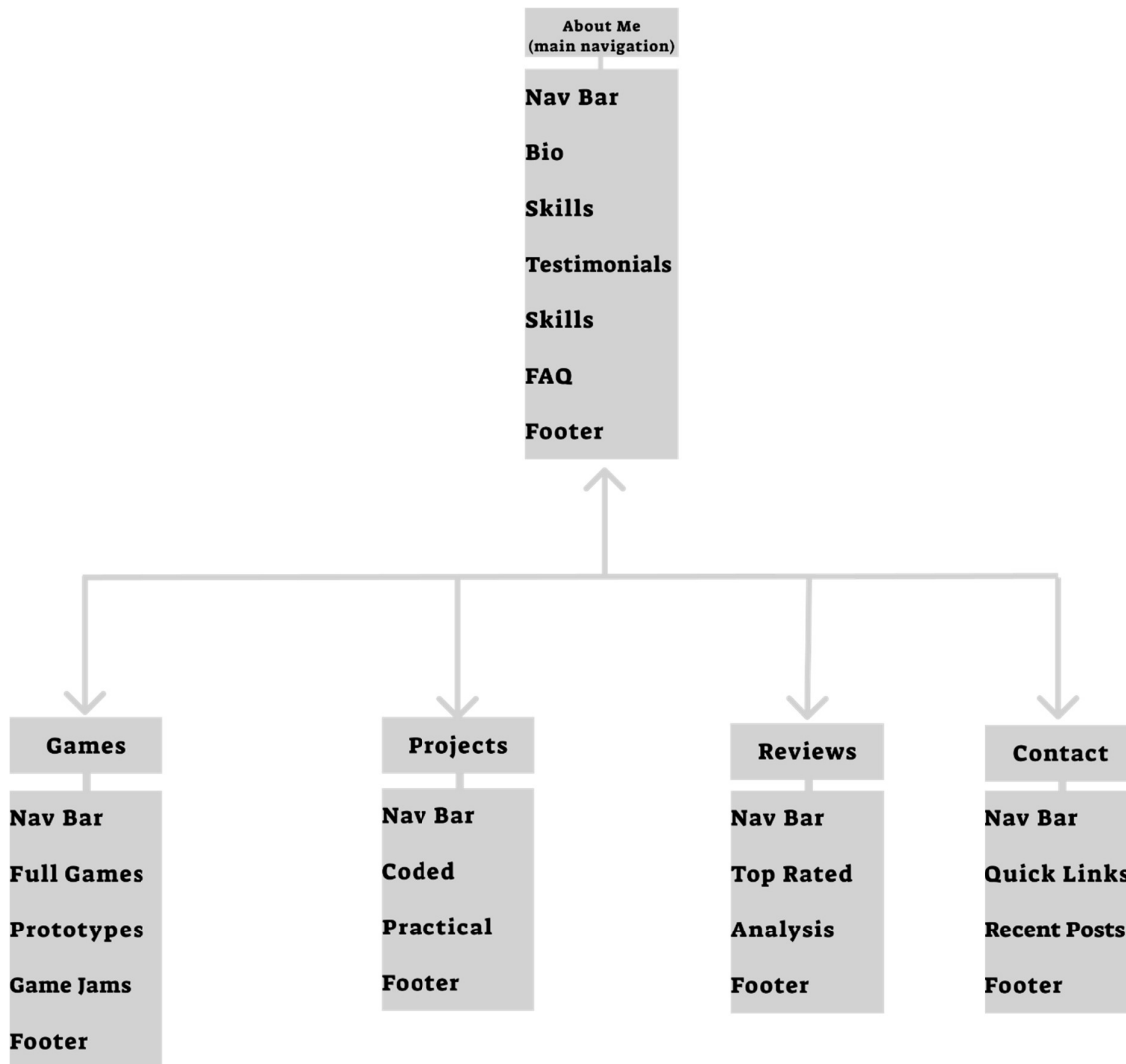


Figure 1 : Sitemap and page inventory for the portfolio website

Figure 1 shows a hierarchical diagram outlining the structure and relationships of all the pages of this portfolio website. [2] The navigation is quite standard where a navigation bar will lead users to each site. There is only a maximum of one depth for each page, no page will lead to a child page.

The following section provides information about what the purpose of the pages are and what content is on each page.

About

This page will serve as the landing page of the website and act as a first impression of my skills and the work I have done. Immediately following the hero section which will be a carousel of projects, games and prototypes will be a brief summary about me, followed by a showcase of my skills and my confidence level in each.

Testimonials from various people will then be displayed, which users can navigate through using the arrows on either side. Lastly, a FAQ section will be included for those who want to learn a little more about the author, James Ihlenfeldt. The page will close with a footer containing quick navigation links and a contact form where users can send a message for any queries .

Games

This page will highlight my full games, prototypes, and game jams I have participated in. Each section will feature a carousel of images with information beside them detailing what I was responsible for and a brief description of the game. This serves the purpose of allowing users to see the work I have produced and the specifics of my contributions.

Projects

This section highlights projects that are not game-focused, including software projects and practical projects. It showcases my skillset and demonstrates that I am well-versed in areas beyond just game design. This will feature projects completed in other university courses, such as electronics, software development, and microprocessors.

When the button is clicked, the carousel will rotate to the next project (inspired by jayvanhutten.com). A timeline will also be displayed showing when I was last employed and how frequently I have been employed.

Reviews

This section aims to highlight my analytical ability, demonstrating that I not only produce games but also consume them and provide valuable insight. These will primarily include reviews from itch.io. The analysis section will draw from past analytical assignments completed in Game Design.

Contact

This section provides multiple ways for users to get in touch with the author, James Ihlenfeldt across various platforms. Below the immediate contact points will be an area where my recent posts from a select few sites are displayed. This allows users to see that I post regularly and maintain an active online presence.

User Persona's

The two specific target the two different schools that I am apart of, that being Software engineering and Game Design.

Software recruiters were researched and a few things were common, these include : Having knowledge in multiple languages [3], being enthusiastic and have experience [4], having an active GitHub and/or work ethic [5], and having a focus on skill and role alignment [6].

Game Developer recruiters were researched too, and common topic were discussed, these being : Having a rich portfolio of games and prototypes [7] [8] as well as taking part in game jams [7]. Having a proficiency in different languages [9] [10]. Additionally, having expertise in at least one game engine [9]. Using a version control is imperative [9], as well as working in a group and performing better with people [7] [8]. Lastly, having the ability to analyse and understand their own game and games they have played displaying critical thinking [7] [10].

Jan Levison — Software Engineering Recruiter

As a SWE recruiter, I search for graduates who are skilful in various coding languages, enthusiastic in their work, and have multiple different projects completed. A graduate with experience would be ideal. An updated and active GitHub repository helps me understand the graduate's work ethic. I search so that I can recruit this graduate to my company for an interview and eventually for a role as a Software Engineer.

Micheal Scott — Game Development Recruiter

As a Game Development recruiter, I search for graduates that have a rich portfolio of games. These can vary from full games, grouped or solo. These can be prototypes, or if they have participated in Game Jams, that would be amazing. A proficiency in coding languages is a must. Expertise in at least one game engine is crucial. The graduate should know how to use version control. A graduate that can work in a group will perform better in my analysis. A graduate that can analyse and understand their own games, as well as games that they have played, shows critical thinking and an understanding of games on a deeper level.

User Flows

Figure 2 and Figure 3 explains the ideal path that each user would take when exploring the website. This is from the initial interaction with the landing page to the end of contact the author, James Ihlenfeldt. [2]

A game developer recruiter seeks out recent graduates for their business. As a GD recruiter they will seek out the skills needed, games and prototypes they have worked on, additionally seeking out if the graduate has not only consumed but also produced games in reviews and analysis .

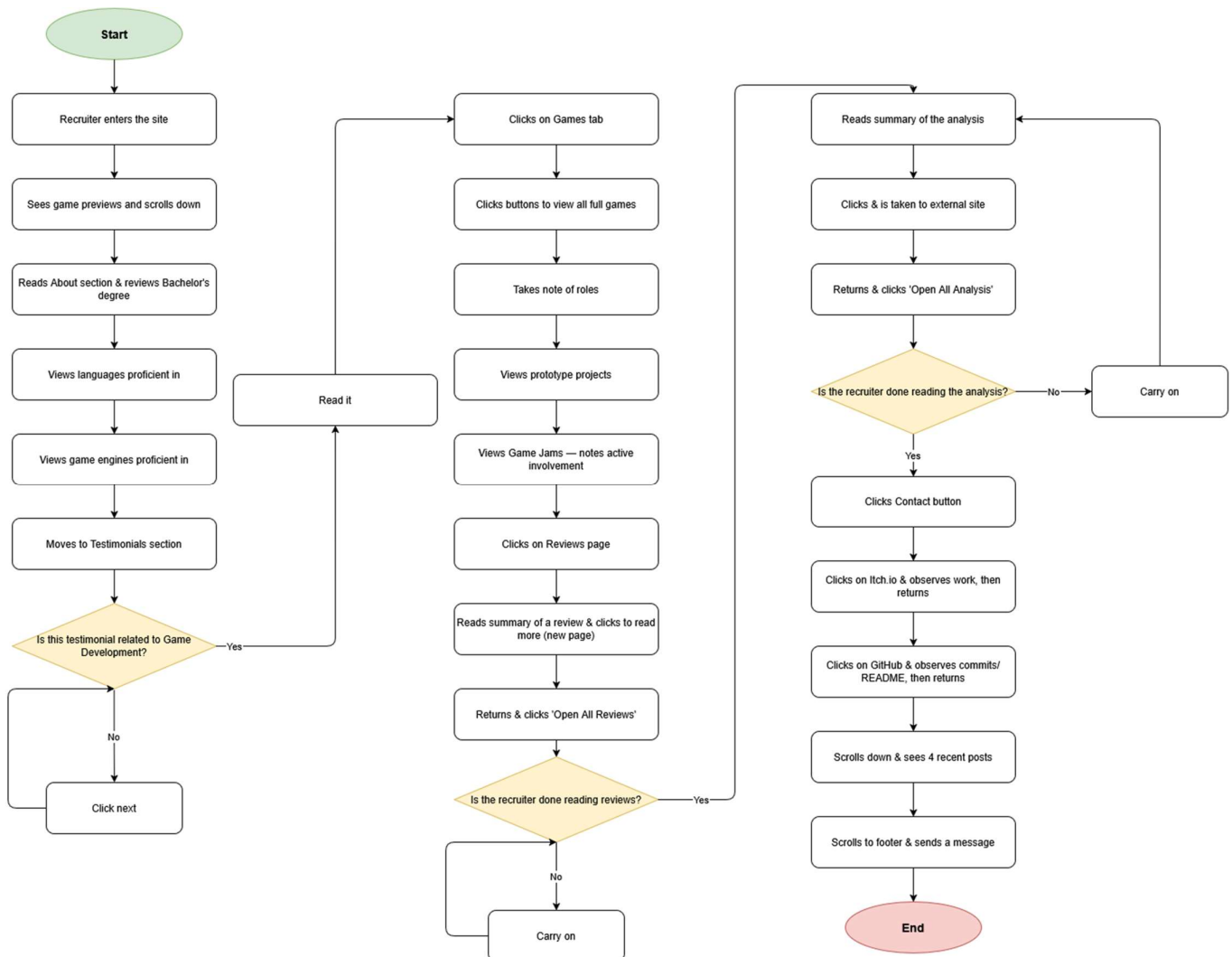


Figure 2 : Game Developer Recruiter's flow chart

A software engineer recruiter seeks out recent graduates for their business.
As a SWE recruiter they will seek out the skills needed, projects worked on and how often they have been recruited or have had work.

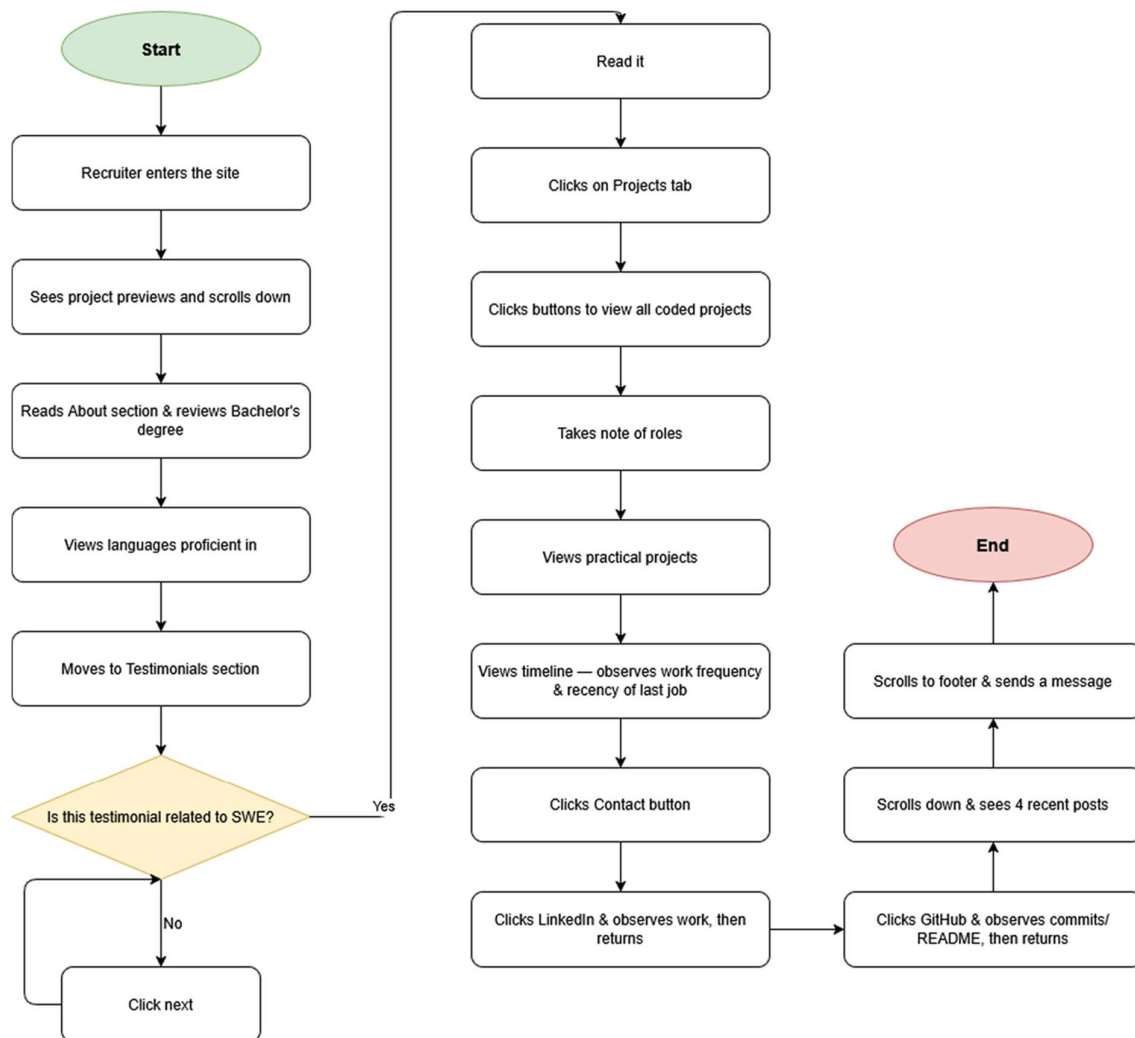


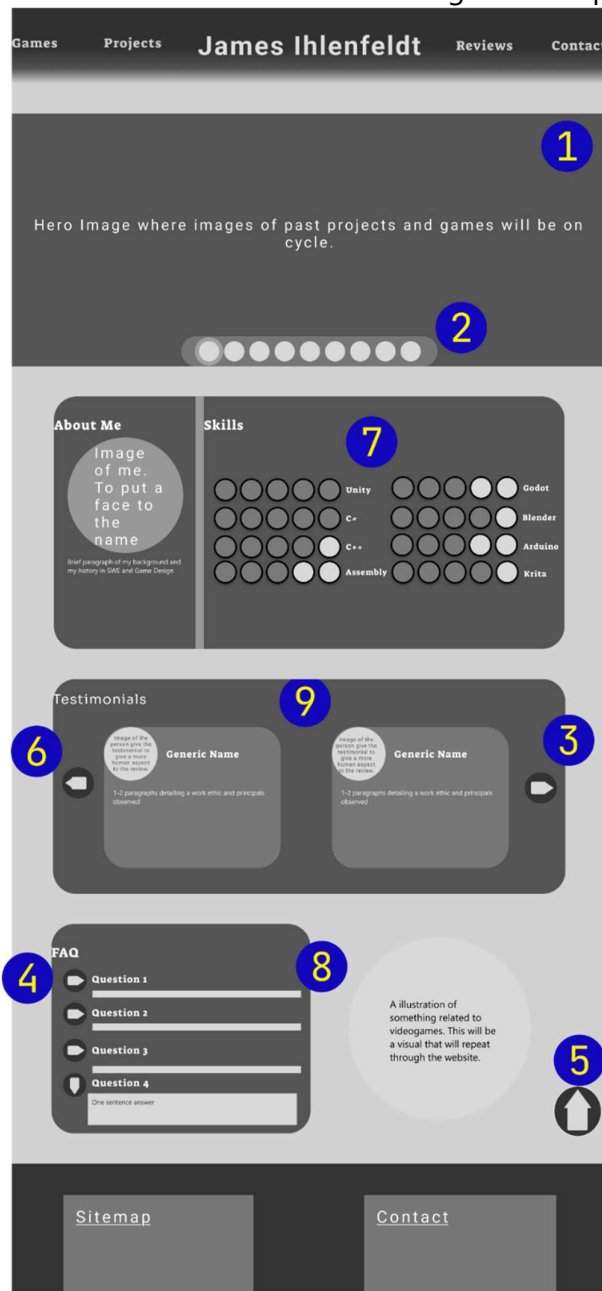
Figure 3 Software Developer Recruiter's flowchart

Wireframes

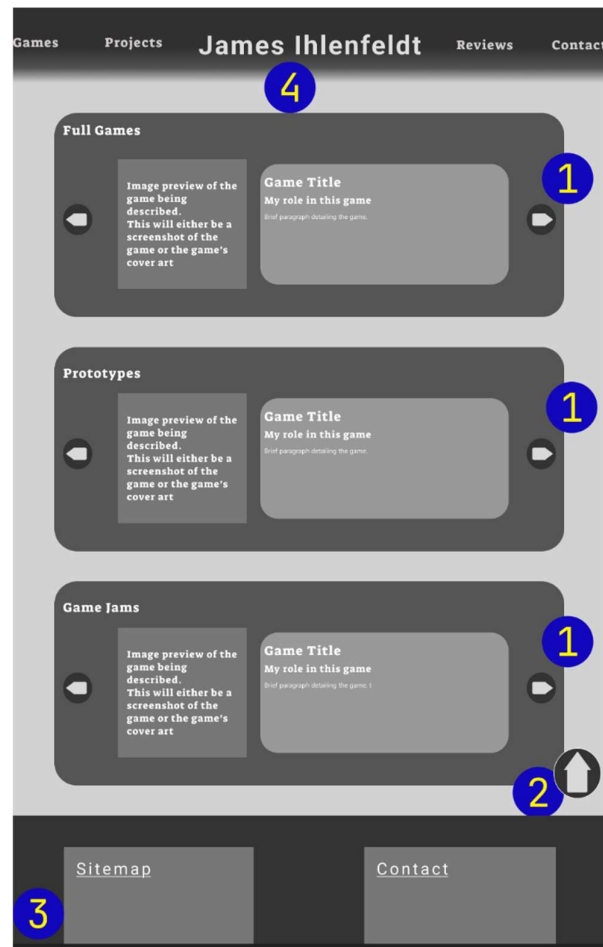
Desktop Wireframes

This section provides the mid-fidelity versions of the website. This includes a refined layout, a proper structure, use of appropriate whitespace and more detailed content compared to the low-fidelity wireframes. These aim to connect the design and the thinking of the author. [2]

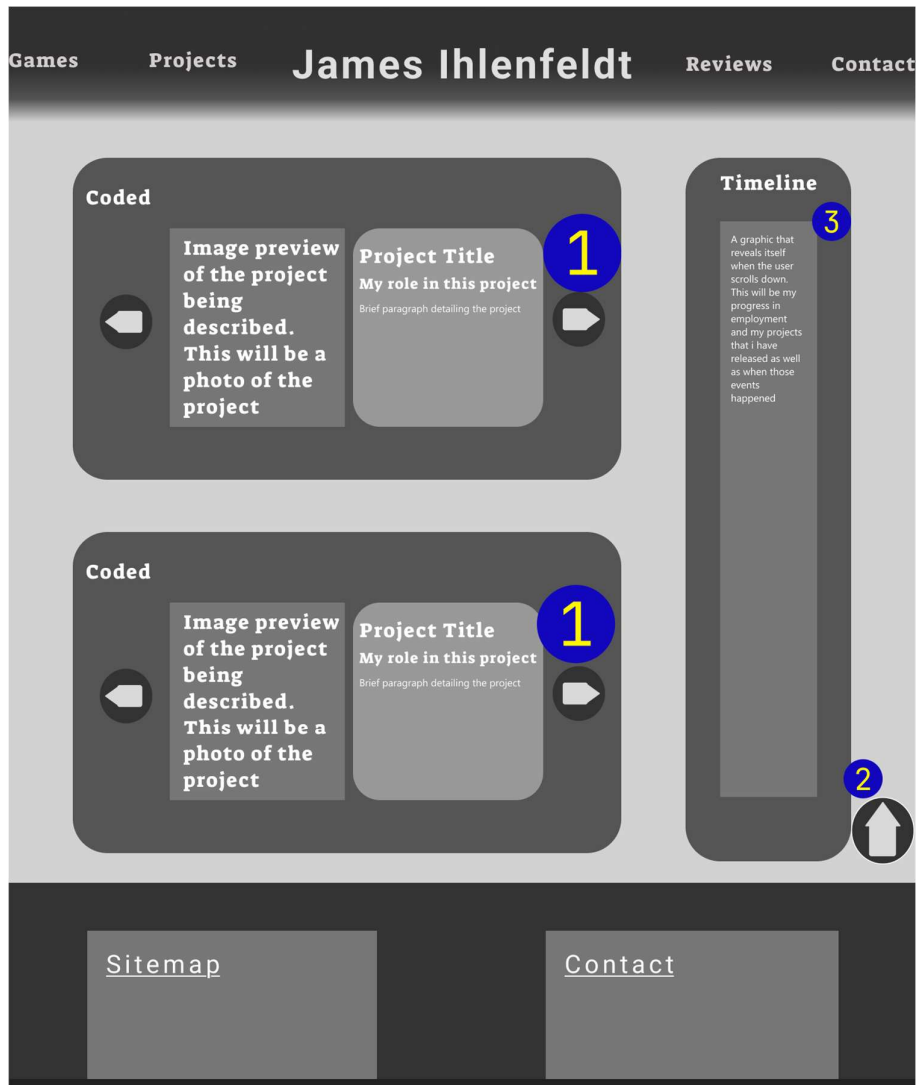
Additionally, annotations are present on the wireframes, these intend to explain the design principles and communicate behaviour. Some annotations are repeated to further reinforce the thinking and interpretation.



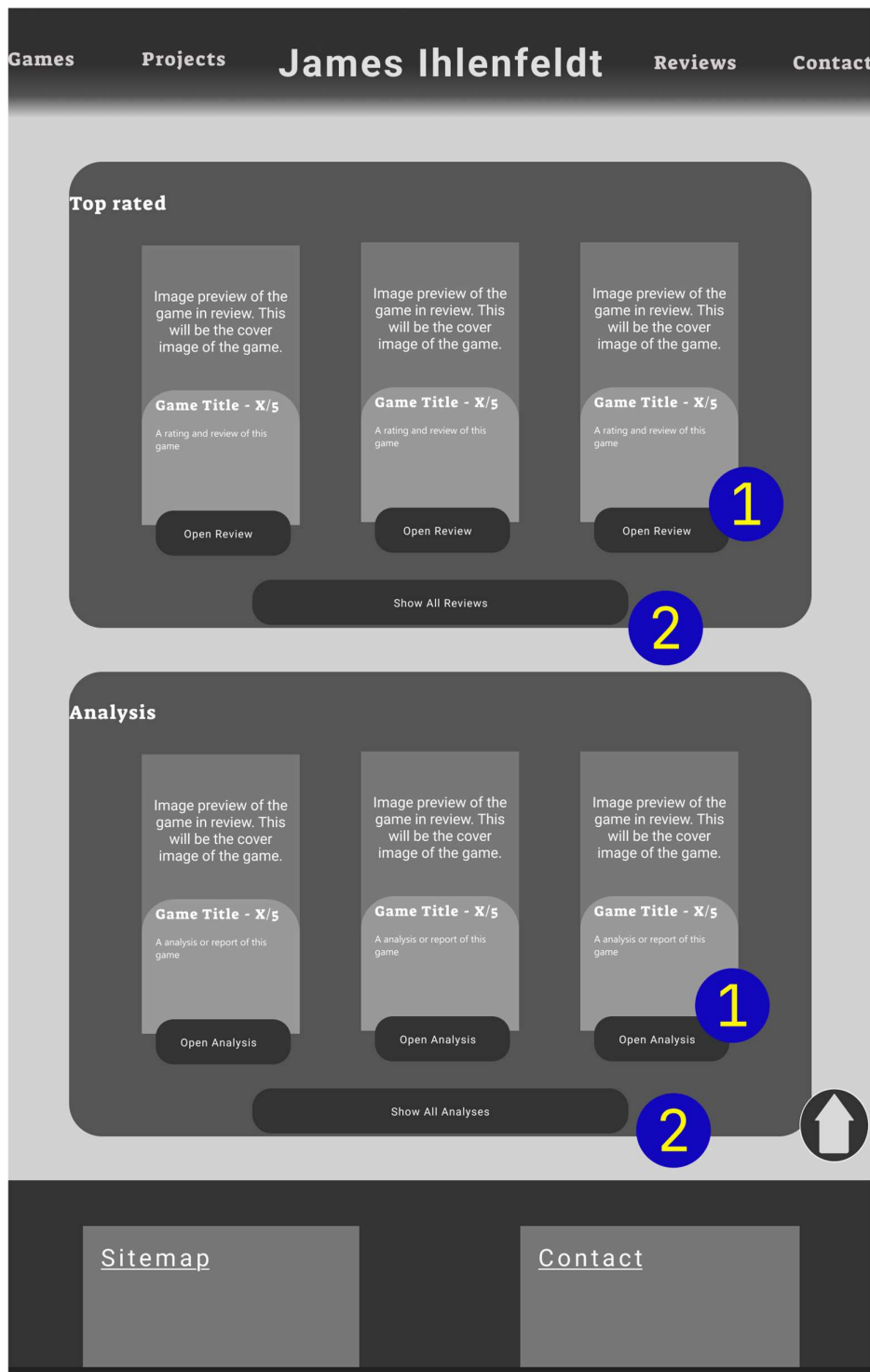
1. The image will be a carousel of games, projects, and blogs.
2. JS will be used at the bottom to add bubbles that the user can select to navigate to that image.
3. The user will be able to navigate through these by pressing the arrows on either side.
4. When users click on the arrows, the section expands to show the answers of the FAQ.
5. The back to top button will have a progress tracker showing how far the user has scrolled through the website.
6. Buttons are modelled after D-pad arrows, hinting at game design.
7. **Skills section** — Circles then names. This causes an alignment where the text has a solid place next to the circles. The alternative caused too much space between the words and the circles. [1]
8. **FAQ** — The bars provide separation of the information and will expand when the arrow is selected. This creates a visual connectedness between the selected question and the answer. The separation allows for a distinct distinction between the questions.
9. **Testimonials** — Here, the testimonials and the about me section line up and the format is repeated, linking the testimonials to James Ihlenfeldt.



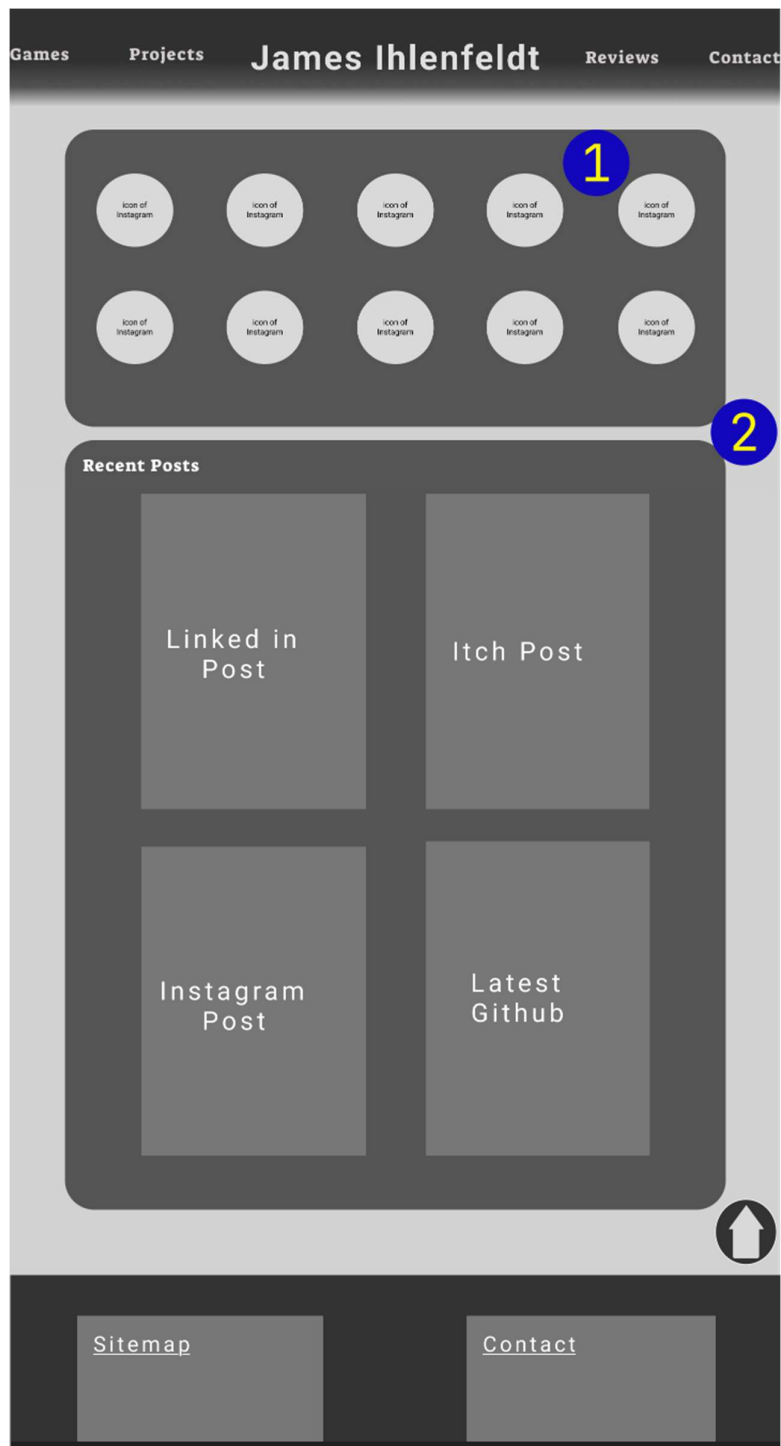
1. The user will be able to navigate through these by pressing the arrows on either side.
2. The back to top button will have a progress tracker showing how far the user has scrolled through the website.
3. Footer — The bar at the bottom prevents the sections from abruptly ending, which would create the visual impression that there is more to the site than there is. The bar provides a definite end to the site, which is in stark contrast to the header, which fades out.
4. The name is centered to show importance, with the links to either side. Although they are not grouped, they are similar in appearance and are therefore still visually linked. A contrast is created by the logo/James Ihlenfeldt being in bold, a different typeface, and having centre alignment, whereas the links are regular, a thinner typeface, smaller, and are right/left aligned against the edges of the page. The navbar will be sticky to the top of the page, allowing for easy access at all times. Additionally, the navbar will be semi-transparent to avoid obscuring content behind it. The navbar will be JS-driven, with pages added through dynamic updating of the DOM based on the pages available. Nav items will be distributed evenly across the width of the page..



1. The user will be able to navigate through these by pressing the arrows on either side.
2. The back to top button will have a progress tracker showing how far the user has scrolled through the website.
3. A timeline that scrolls with the page as the user scrolls down.



1. The use of "Open Review" and "Open Analysis" alludes to an external tab being opened, rather than a simple expansion within the page. On click, the JS will redirect to the document in a new tab.
2. Using "Show all x" alludes to the section expanding to display all reviews, which is distinct from simply using "Open."

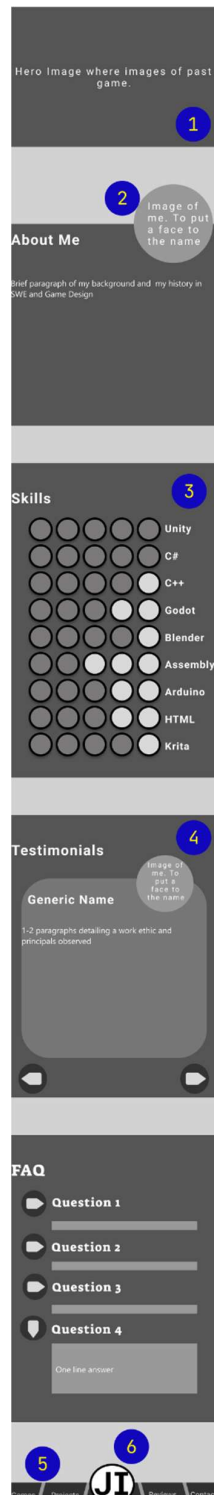
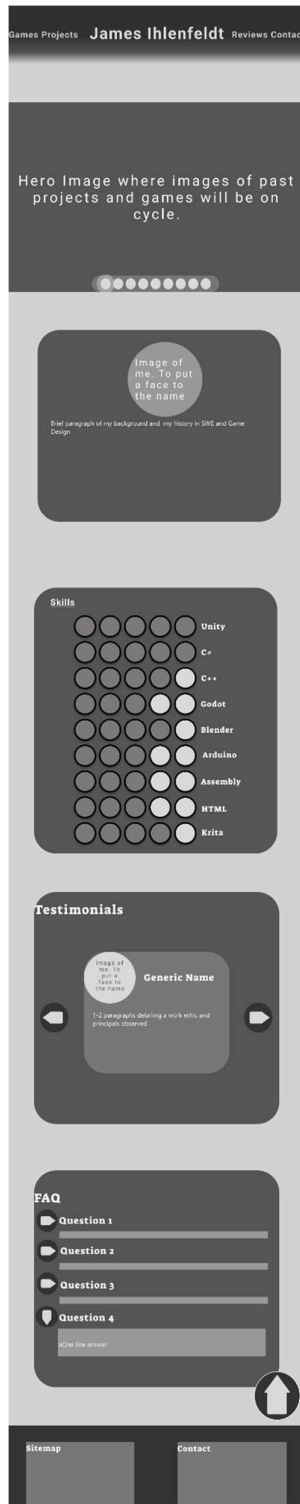


1. Using "Show all x" alludes to the section expanding to display all reviews, which is distinct from simply using "Open."
2. The rounded corners give a less rigid and more approachable appearance. The final design will include a glass-like background for the panels. The roundness of 55px complements this style, as the curved edges are characteristic of the Frutiger Aero aesthetic (which will be explained in detail in the design and visual approach section.).

Responsive Wireframes

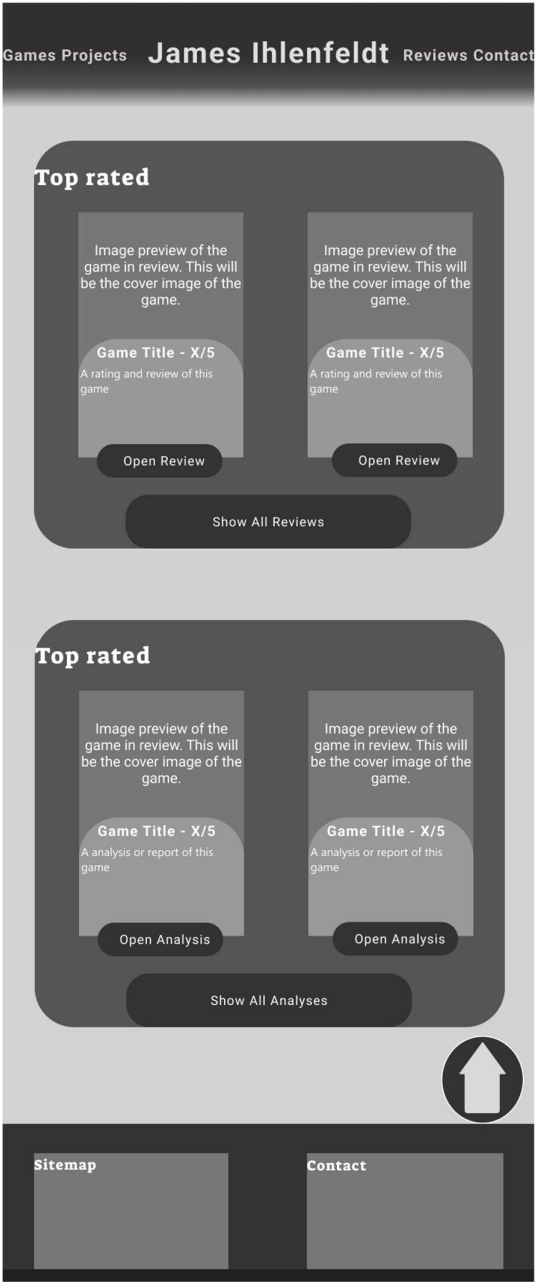
About page - Responsive Wireframes

This section shows the responsive design of two of the above pages. These are crucial for mobile and tablet screens where the screen size, devices, and orientations differ from user to user. [2]



1. Only one image will be displayed here, as swiping as selecting images will be more difficult on smaller screens.
2. The About section is changed, with the profile picture placed above the About Me section. This is to provide more space for the text.
3. Skills are aligned beneath each other, as they are in the tablet version. This is to prevent users from having to scroll horizontally.
4. Testimonials also receive the treatment of having the image placed above the text. In addition to allowing for more space, this creates a visual similarity with the About Me section, linking the testimonials to the author, James Ihlenfeldt.
5. The navbar is a sticky navbar fixed to the bottom of the screen, allowing for constant access to navigation. The nav buttons have been changed to shaped buttons for easier pressing. If more pages or subpages were created, a hamburger/dropdown menu would be preferred, as this would be easier to manage and would keep information that is not immediately needed hidden. The logo "James Ihlenfeldt" has been simplified to "JI," lending itself to brand recognition. Placing it in the centre subtly aligns with the home button found on most devices, indicating to the user how to return to the homepage.

Review page - Responsive Wireframes



- 1. Reviews and analyses will be displayed below each other, with only two shown by default. This single-column layout allows for simple swiping down the page.
- 2. When pressed, all cards will be shown. However, a sticky button will be present at all times to close the section immediately. This prevents users from having to scroll back to the top or all the way to the bottom just to close the section.

JavaScript implementation

Image Display :

Images will be displayed one at a time, happening in a cycle. A bar will be filled in the middle center with circles that will represent the image's current position. When pressed, that image will be displayed and the cycle will continue from there. This is found on about page.

Carousel :

Buttons will be place on either side of the main area of the carousel. A next button and previous button will allow the user to navigate through the different topics in the carousel. This will be found on projects and game pages.

Dropdown :

When the button is pressed, it will expand a section below it, revealing more information, in this case it will reveal the answer to the question posed. In the other case, multiple cards will be shown with reviews and/or analyses. This will be found on the about page under the FAQ section and will appear on the reviews page, under both sections on the page.

Return to top :

The return to top element has a circumference that changes how filled it according to how far the user has scrolled down the page. The further down the user has scrolled, the more the circumference is filled in a radial fashion from 0deg to all the way to 360 degrees. This will be found at the bottom right of all pages

Timeline Display :

As the user scrolls down the page, more on the timeline will fade in. Elements will appear below each other with a date and a title. This will be found on the right hand side of the projects page.

Navigation Bar :

The user will find a navigation bar with links to the other pages found on the left and right sides. The links will be generated based on the available pages. This will appear at the top of every page.

Design Direction & Visual Approach

Typography

This section explains the use of text to style and arrange the website.

Segoe UI was used for the body text. It has previously been used as a UI typeface in an operating system. The apertures are open and it is a sans-serif font. The use of Segoe UI provides a distinctive word shape such as the "a" and the "e" or the "r" and "n" (ae - rn) in words which get confused due to their similar shape.

Suez One was used for headings. It contrasts with the body text by being bold and slightly more rounded. It is a serif font, which helps grab attention, as the serifs slow the reader's eye and draw focus. The roundness provides a softer effect for the user's eyes and eases comfortability, as opposed to a Times New Roman heading, which is rigid and abrupt.

Pairing a serif and a sans-serif font is a good strategy, as serif fonts are typically used for headings while sans-serif fonts are better suited to large amounts of body text. [11] This creates a deliberate contrast between the two fonts, clarifying that the difference in information hierarchy is intentional and not accidental [1].

The best practices were used to dictate text size. Figure 4 shows the name of the font where the prefix "D" means desktop, "M" means mobile and "T" Tablet and the first number representing the text size.

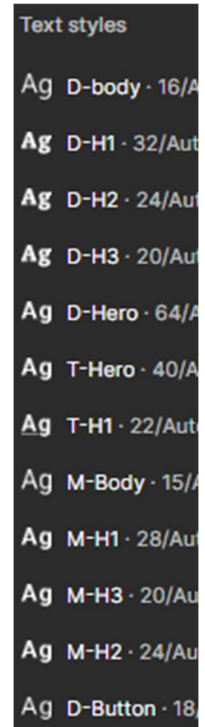


Figure 4 : Various font sizes used

Colour Palette

A colour palette allows consistency, an identity and supports hierarchy in a website. Figure 5 shows the colour palette and their role in the colour palette. [12]

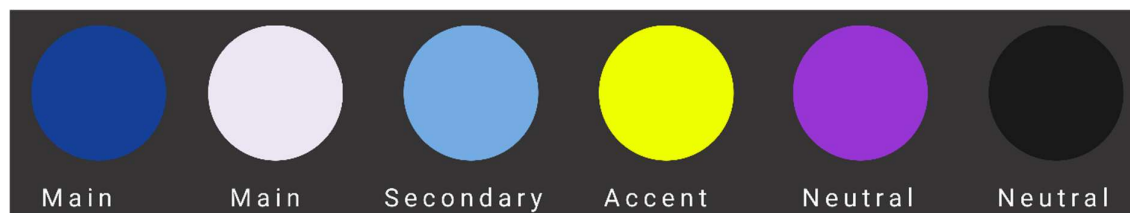


Figure 5 : Chosen colour palette

The two main colours will be a dark blue/Model Ultramarine (#164098) and an off-white/Lavender White (#ECE6F4). The secondary colour is a light blue/Flat Blue (#73ABE2), the accent colour will be a bright yellow/Hot Lemon (#EDFF00), and the neutral colour will be a light purple/Dark Orchid (#9735D4). Text will be a dark black / Casual Black (#19191A).

These colours were all individually tested for the different types of colour blindness. The only issue was with red-green colour blindness, where the main blue and neutral purple appeared as slightly different shades of blue. This will be taken into consideration when applying colours to the website. Figure 6 shows a visual representation of what users with the ` colour blindness see.

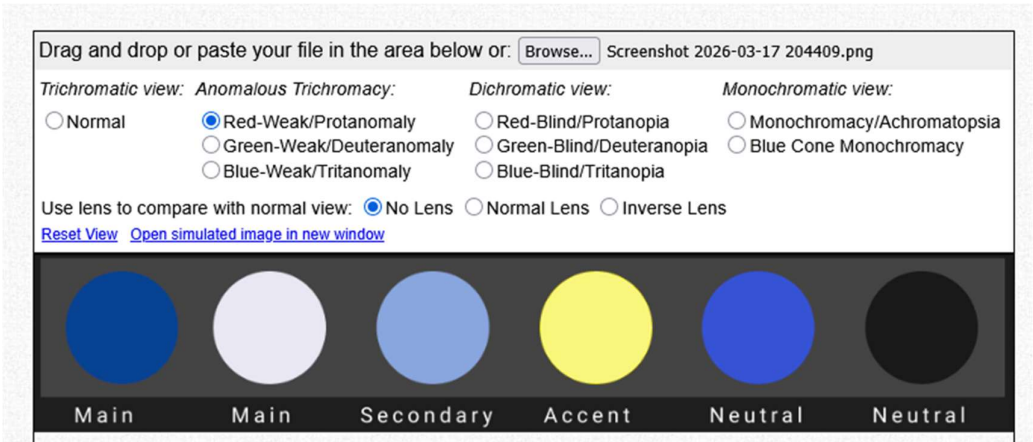


Figure 6 : Colour palette with red-green colour blindness

Blue and off-white will be the main colours, making up approximately 60% of the palette, with the blue having a glassy effect applied to it across each section. The off-white will be used as the borders of these sections, creating a sharp and contrasting break between sections on the page (contrast score of 7.74:1). This will be prominent against the dark background.

The light blue will serve as the secondary colour, making up about 30% of the pallette, helping to elevate items that require visual separation from the sections. Although it does not clear all contrast checks, it does pass the graphical objects and user interface components tests, which is the context in which it will be used.

The yellow will be used as an accent colour to guide user action and/or attention. It contrasts well with the main blue, with a contrast score of 8.51:1.

The purple will be used sparingly as a neutral colour, applied when sections need some breathing room between them.

Figure 7 shows how extensive contrast checks were performed with the help of <https://contrast-grid.eightshapes.com/> which creates a grid of all your colours and the contrast ratings for each colour.

	Background	Text	#19191A	#ECE6F4	#164098	#73ABE2	#9735D4	#EDFF00
#19191A		Text		Text	Text	Text	Text	Text
		AAA 14.3	DNP 1.8	AAA 7.2	AA10 3.1	AAA 15.8		
#ECE6F4		Text		Text	Text	Text	Text	Text
		AAA 14.3	AAA 7.7	DNP 1.9	AA 4.5	DNP 1.1		
#164098		Text	Text		Text	Text	Text	Text
		DNP 1.8	AAA 7.7		AA10 3.9	DNP 1.7	AAA 8.5	
#73ABE2		Text	Text	Text		Text	Text	Text
		AAA 7.2	DNP 1.9	AA10 3.9		DNP 2.2	DNP 2.1	
#9735D4		Text	Text	Text	Text		Text	Text
		AA10 3.1	AA 4.5	DNP 1.7	DNP 2.2		AA 5	
#EDFF00		Text	Text	Text	Text	Text		
		AAA 15.8	DNP 1.1	AAA 8.5	DNP 2.1	AA 5		

16 Figure 7 :A contrast check with all the colours. Some will fail however, in most of these cases that combination wont happen in the website

In terms of colour psychology, the dark blue and light blue convey a tone of peace, security, and confidence. [12] The accent yellow, aside from its relation to the use of yellow paint to direct players in games, is attention-grabbing against the dark blue and brings a sense of joy, optimism, and freshness to the site [12]. The sparing use of purple associates the website with ambition, creativity, and success [12]. Using the off-white as a border represents the safety [12] of what is contained within those sections, adds to the modern aesthetic of the page, and evokes a sense of imagination that links with the purple of ambition and the yellow of positivity.

Design Mood and Rationale

The goal of the portfolio website is to bring across a feeling of professionalism and formality with a hint of playfulness and to be approachable. The goal is to reflect a website for both SWE and Game Dev. recruiters. both who appreciate knowledge in the different technologies and appreciate a design that has the individual in it.

The Frutiger Aero's glassmorphism aesthetic gives the website a retro-modern aspect which contrast the minimal flat portfolios in the rest of the industry. This also brings across an acknowledgment of previous designs and how it could be implemented today. Having a consistent colour palette of dark blue, off-white and purple relays brand identity to the site. Lastly, subtle references to games like the dpad arrows or yellow accent resembling yellow pain in games add personality without detracting from the professionalism.

Layout and Grid Strategy

All pages are centre-aligned. Although centre alignment is considered a safe choice because it creates a formal look [1], a left- or right-aligned website would create too much dead space on the opposite side. Additionally, most of the portfolios reviewed were centre-aligned. Various alignment decisions are mentioned in the annotations on the previous pages. To highlight a few: on the About page, the skills display the icon first, followed by the name. This was done intentionally, as having the text on the left-hand side would create an uneven line that could cause confusion as to which skill belongs to which title. The first column uses the separator as a strong line for alignment, and the second column uses the right edge of the section as another strong line to build from.

All text is left-aligned, with the only exception being the navbar.

Most sections of the website are single-column. However, areas that break this pattern include the FAQ and the image section at the bottom of the About page, where the image breaks up the FAQ section to provide contrast to the two content-heavy sections above it. The image also allows for more white space, easing the cognitive load on the user. Secondly, the Projects page features a timeline aligned to the right, creating a two-column layout. This is to visually distinguish it from the very similar-looking Games page, ensuring users are not confused about which page they are on.

Visual Reference

Figure 8 displays the mood board used for inspiration for the website. The blue colour is the most popular in the Frutiger aesthetic, which is the main inspiration for the website. The yellow and blue contrasting colours were developed from suggested colour palette. The opaque glass backgrounds that will be used and later explained were derived from windows 7 application windows and from modern Ui.



Portfolio Inspiration

1. <https://www.jackbromhead.com> : Hero image being games they have worked on, and it being the first thing the user can interact with
2. <http://www.jayvanhutten.com> : Having a course of games that you have worked on and listing the skills under the title.
3. <https://hugo.fyi> : Another use of the hero image being games and projects the author had worked on. However, this site has more details about the code and practical projects
4. <https://chadcable.net/prototypes> : Having the images of the games/prototypes be animated gifs to show case them and to have the ability to further read about each game.
5. <https://gerlogu.com> : Timeline showing details about previous projects
6. <https://109ichiki.com/contact> : Interactive elements on the page including moving/shaking images.

Figure 8 : Created from the Pinterest board:
<https://za.pinterest.com/LahLama/webdev-inspo/>

Interactive element styling

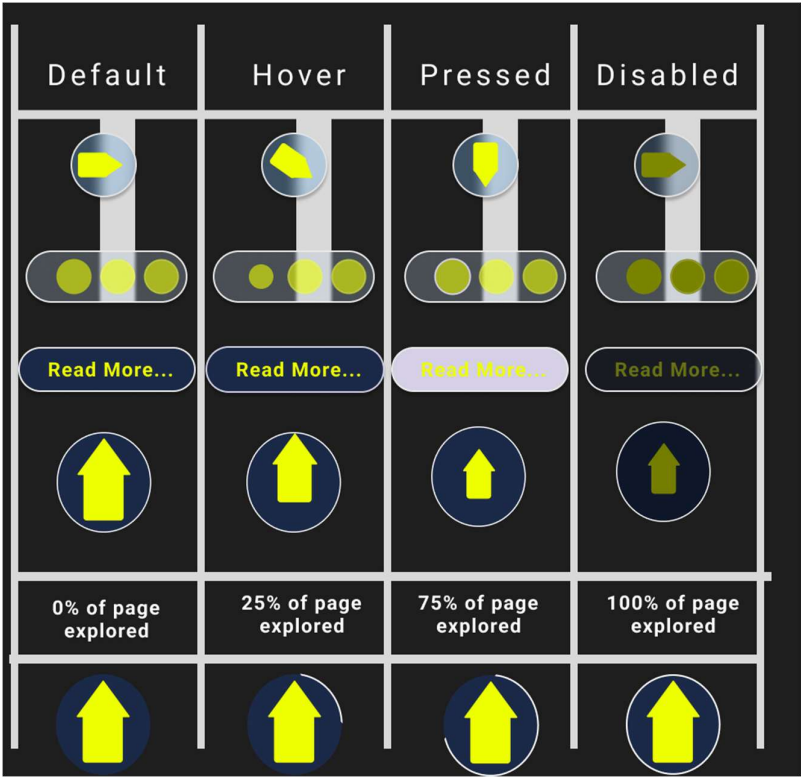


Figure 9 : Table showing the different interactive elements in the website

In figure 9 the hover is used as an in-between state, for the buttons. The general pattern when it came to the disabled sections was to dim the colours of the buttons/interactive elements. From top to bottom the elements will be used as, a dropdown indicator, a position indicator for a image carousel, a button and a return to the top button. The first two elements have a streak of white to show how the background is a opaque background that responds to the background. The last row shows how the return to the top button will change as the user scrolls down the page. Figure 10 shows am example of the sections of information will have an opaque glass background.



Figure 10 : Example of the cards that will be used in the website. The colours are not final.

Repository Structure & Organisation

The 4 main folders under the main folder will be the JavaScript folder, CSS folder, HTML folder, and Assets folder. The necessity of splitting these folders comes from both convention and ease of use. When referencing the files in the code, only one path will be needed for the CSS files, and similarly for JS. Assets is an umbrella term

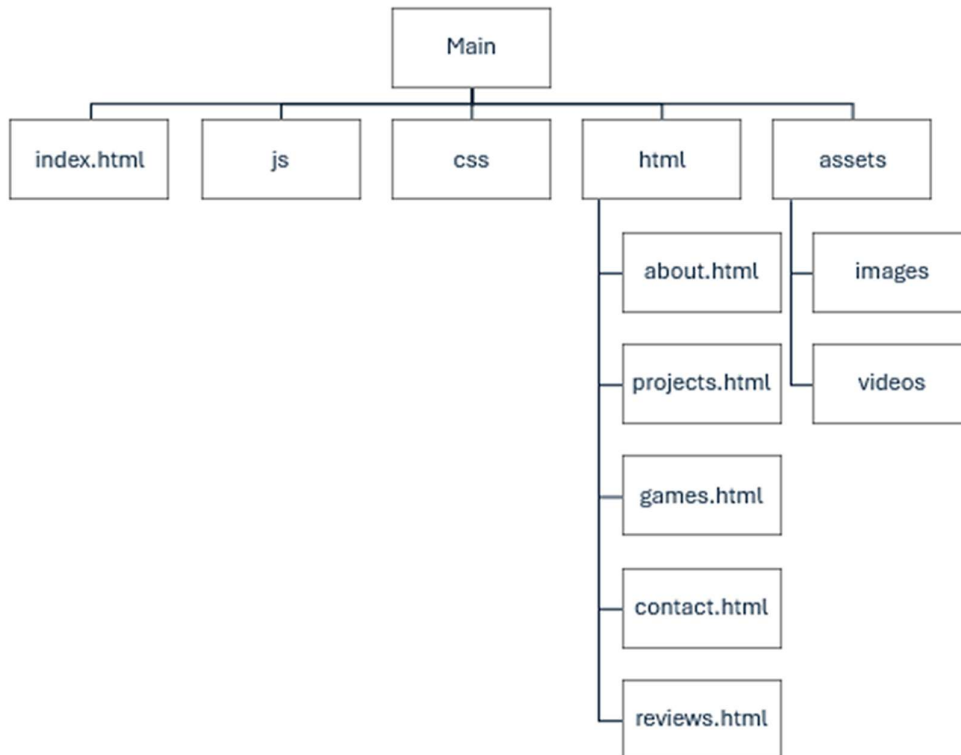


Figure 11 : The repository file structure that will be used

used for any images or videos used, such as screenshots and covers from games, coded projects, or photos of practical projects.

The index.html file sits directly under the main folder, making it the landing page of the website and allowing access to the other pages within the site. The HTML folder will house all other HTML files needed in the project, with the exception of index.html. The CSS folder will house the CSS files required by the different pages. The JS folder will house the individual scripts needed for specific pages as well as those shared across all pages.

Bibliography

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- [12] A. Imaan, "Design Theory Week 5 Visual (UI) Design Pt.1".